

Lecture 7 War, Peace and International Security

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International Relations



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**IR Theories
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Europe**



Next week

Key Debates and Readings

Questions to be considered:

Is peace the continuation of war by other means?

Is war always between sovereign citizens?

How are international and domestic dimensions of war and peace intertwined?

Required readings:

1. Heywood, A., & Whitham, B. (2023). Global politics (3rd ed., Chapter 11: War and Peace). London: Red Globe Press.
2. Barkawi (2016). Decolonising war. European Journal of International security, 1(2), 199-214

Definitions



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The concept of War- Whose war?

- ‘We all think we know what war is, but the term “war” has a history and cannot simply be taken for granted.
- **Scale or magnitude:** ‘The United Nations defines a ‘major conflict’ as one in which at least 1,000 deaths occur annually. However, this is an arbitrary figure, which would, for example, exclude the Falklands War of 1982, which is almost universally regarded as a war. (Heywood)’
- Blitzkrieg
- Total War
- Hegemonic war
- Guerrilla war
- Revolutionary war

The concept of War

BBC



International Relations Theories and War



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A realist approach to war

WAR = POWER

*‘war is simply a continuation of political intercourse,
with the addition of other means’
It is not peace or war*

(Karl von Clausewitz, On War, 1833; read also: Sun Tsu, The Art of War, approx. 5th century BC)



There is a co-constitution of war and politics,
war and society, war and economy, war and technology,
war and culture (Barkawi)

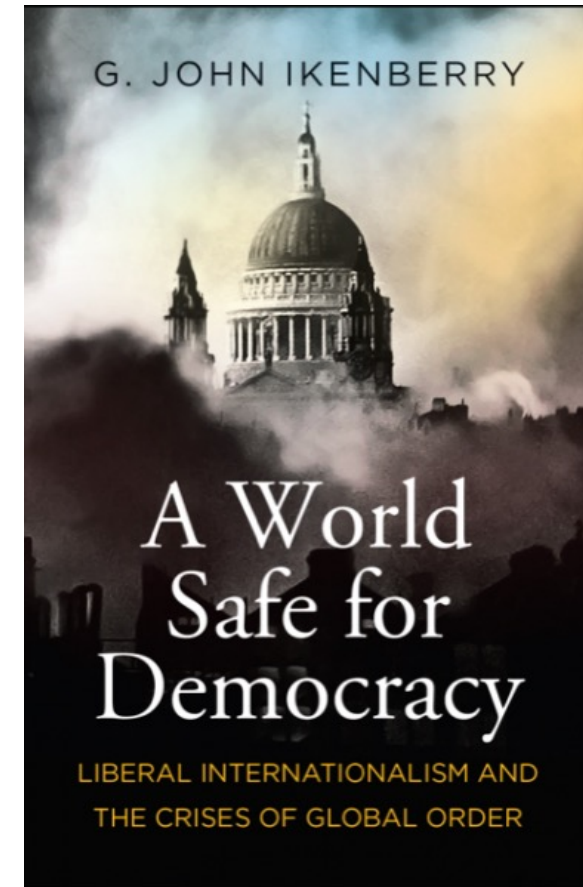
Idealism

- Perpetual peace
- Internationalism
- Collective security -> concept of Security communities of K. Deutsch 1957
- Idea of Just War, what is morally justifiable



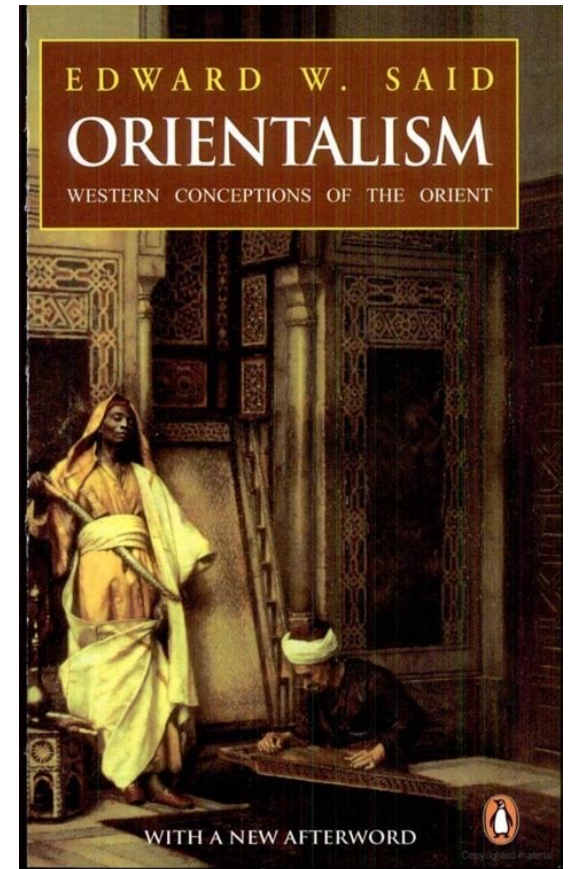
Liberalism

- War is a disturbing fact for liberals
- IR can be improved with peace and progress gradually replacing war
- Liberal Democracy to be promoted
- Importance of the role of IOs and Trade
- **Challenge:** how to protect states from foreign states while keeping individual liberty
- Democratic Peace Theory
- Daniel Deudney and G. John Ikenberry (1999):
 1. importance of international law and agreements – UN
 2. Spread of free trade and capitalism to decrease conflict and war
 3. International norms such as human rights, democracy and rule of law



Post-colonialism

- Importance given to inequalities, disparities over power
- Brings studies of race/ethnicity, gender and class in understanding IR
- Highlight Eurocentricism of IR
- IR traditionalist theorist see the world as anarchist, but postcolonialism see it as a hierarchy



The case for post-colonial war studies

- **‘Modern Intervention’**
- ‘intervention is a distinctive technology of colonial-modern rule, specifically, one that erects and polices the difference between sovereign and quasi-sovereign entities via a standard of Civilisation’ (R. Shilam, 2013)
- **Relationship between neo-liberalism and war**
- ‘Small Wars have enabled world-order projects like capitalist modernity, and they have shaped politics and society in the global North and South since the early modern era’ (Barkawi)

Decolonising War

- To critically consider how Eurocentrism informed the categories of war
- It is not adequate just to investigate war in the Global South; decolonizing does not only mean shifting our geographic focus
- **THREE KEY ELEMENTS OF EUROCENTRIC CONCEPT OF WAR**
 - • War and peace are opposites
 - • War is amongst sovereign and national states
 - • War is either international or domestic (civil)
- *Decolonising is about ‘critiquing the ways in which Eurocentric ideas and historiographies have informed the basic categories of social and political thought’*
- *Barkawi, T. (2016). Decolonising war. European Journal of International Security, 1(2), 199-214. doi:10.1017/eis.2016.7*

What is War from a decolonial perspective?

- **EUROCENTRIC CONCEPT OF WAR**

- • How Eurocentric ideas and histories have shaped basic categories of social and political thought.
- • How the hegemony of European imperialism and the nation-state shaped the concept of war.

- **HOW IS WAR UNDERSTOOD?**

- • It occurs between states.
- • Fought between regular armed forces.

- **WHAT IS NOT WAR?**

- • Insurgencies, emergencies, interventions, uprisings, occupations.
- • Colonial settlement, territorial expansion, insurrection.

Decolonising War



War and peace are opposites

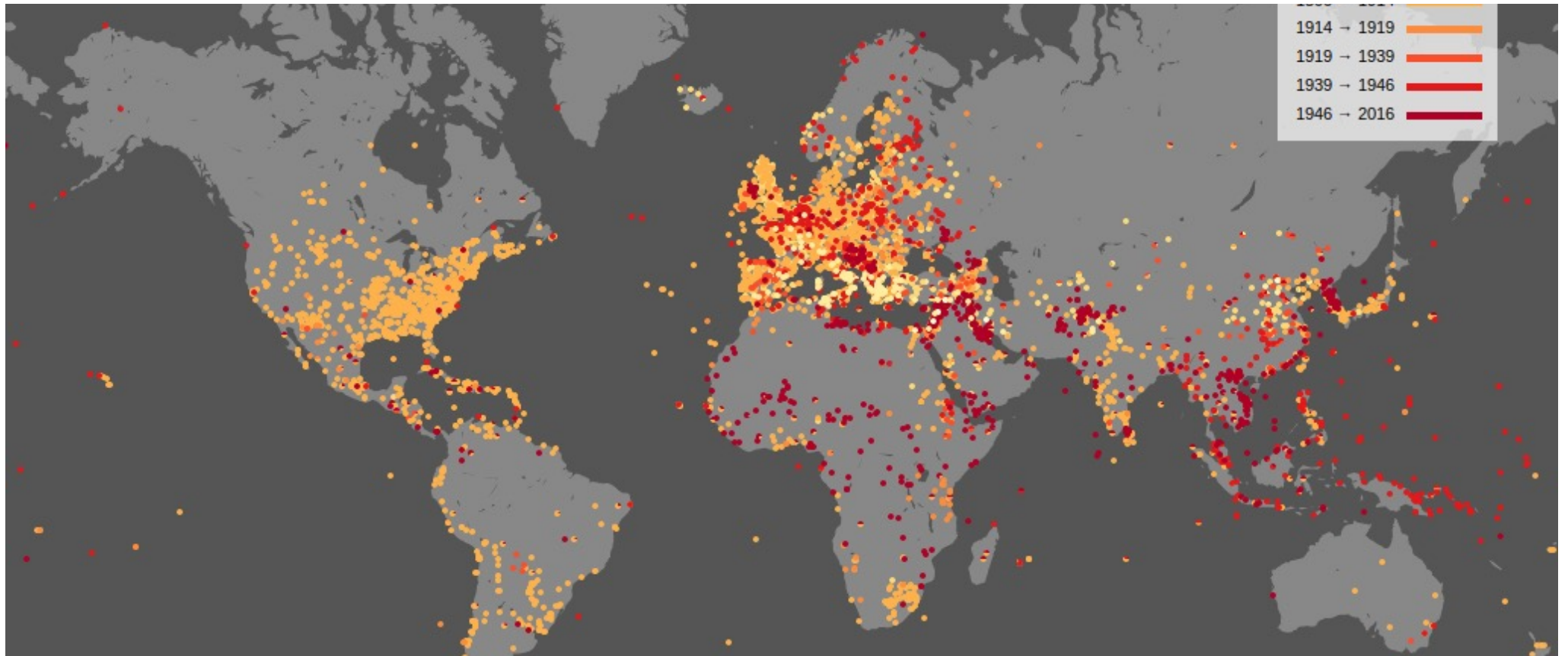
Major periods of history are characterised as 'war' or 'peace'. Major wars become interruptions of peace

International law distinguishes between conditions of war and peace and the laws that appertain to each

Barkawi citation by a US marine stationed in Ramadi during the Iraq war

'America is not at war. The Marine Corps is at War, America is at the mall.' Barkawi, p.202

Mapping War ([source: LAB1100](#))



Just War Theory

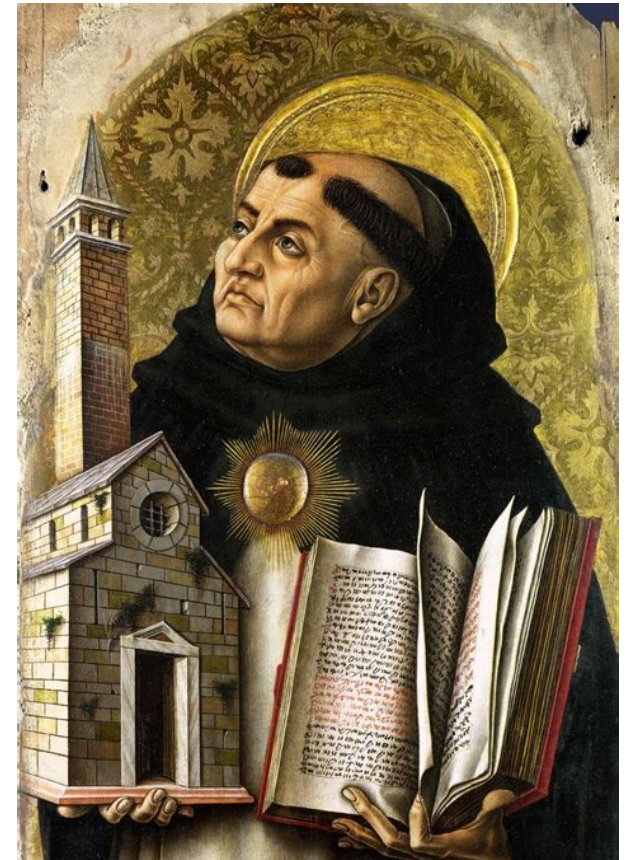
- ‘A war that, in its purpose and conduct, meets certain ethical standards, and so is (allegedly) morally justified’ (Heywood)

Principles of jus ad bellum (just recourse to war):

- Last resort.
- Just cause..
- Legitimate authority.
- Right intention.
- Reasonable prospect of success.
- Proportionality.

Principles of jus in bello (just conduct in war):

- Discrimination.
- Proportionality.
- Humanity.

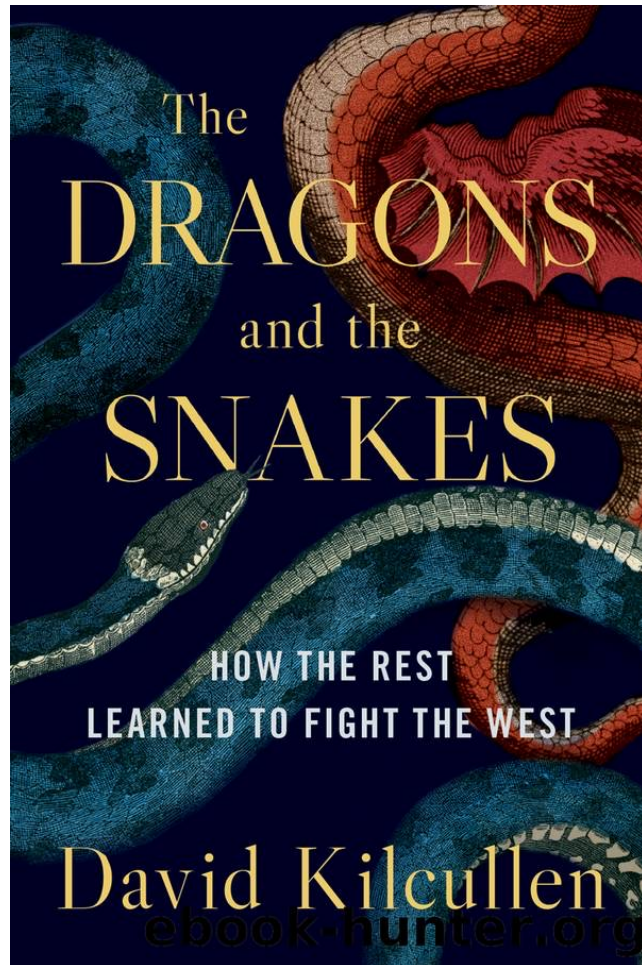


New Wars



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Contemporary War



Main takeaway: it is that the military model pioneered by US forces in the 1991 Gulf War— the high- tech, high precision, high- cost suite of networked systems that won the Gulf War so quickly and brought Western powers such unprecedented battlefield dominance in the quarter century since then— is no longer working. (Kilcullen 2020, p. 6).



Russia, China, Iran and North Korea



non-state actors and threats from state collapse

Snakes & Dragons



- the West wrongly assumed that dragons would accept the colonial terms under which they were expected to orbit around an American empire with its ally and client states. (Kilcullen 2020, p. 24).
- Kilcullen says that especially Russia and China ended up refusing to be drawn into the orbit of the West accepting its terms.
- ‘Chinese military planners began to focus on the “informationalization” of the PLA, bringing it into the modern digital era and renewing their emphasis on political warfare, along with its key subcomponents –known to Chinese planners as the “three warfares” –of psychological warfare, public opinion warfare, and legal warfare or “lawfare.”’ (Kilcullen 2020, p. 26)

Iraq, Afghanistan, the war on terror



- What used to be known as 'war' was increasingly replaced by activities such as 'peacekeeping', 'counterinsurgency', 'humanitarian reconstruction', 'counterterrorism', and 'military advisory missions'.
- Although there were already various bewilderingly diverse operations in the last decade of the 20th century, Iraq War was probably **the last 'conventional' war fought –first won and then turning into a loss –by two standing armies however asymmetrical this may have been.**
- Soon the global war on terror turned into **a threat without enemies**. A problem here was that 'the idea of terrorism as a single, unified opponent—one that could stand in for a traditional state-based adversary and be considered to have an overarching intent and objectives' (Kilcullen 2020, p. 14) ended being an illusion.
-

The private military and security industry

- **A modern factor of security**
- The private military and security industry (PMSI) emerged in its contemporary form during the 1960s, expanded significantly following the end of the Cold War, and had achieved sufficient capacity after 9/11 to account, at times, for the majority of deployed military forces in Iraq and Afghanistan.
- The development is the contracting by sovereign states of critical national security tasks to the private military and security companies (PMSCs) that comprise the PMSI.
- NGOs and multinational corporations also use PMSCs.
- The rise of PMSCs to perform critical national security and military tasks subverts deeply held institutional logics of state power, sovereignty, and the use of violence. The activities of PMSCs are seen as the removal of violence from the public domain of accountability and control.



PMSI- legitimacy & accountability

- ‘Despite its controversial nature, the PMSI has achieved sufficient legitimacy since the end of the Cold War to account at times for the majority of military personnel deployed in Afghanistan and Iraq’ (Baum and McGahan, 2013:3)
- > importance of actors’ expertise, reputation, and credibility based in sovereign structures,
- >second, to structural shifts that reconfigured the military field in ways that both enabled and constrained agency
- **Montreux Document**, 2008 Switzerland and the ICRC – legal obligations of states regarding PMSCs activities during armed conflict
- Outsourcing to private companies with a ‘rising share of the force mix in international military and peacekeeping operations (Schwartz, 2009 in Baum and McGahan, 2013)

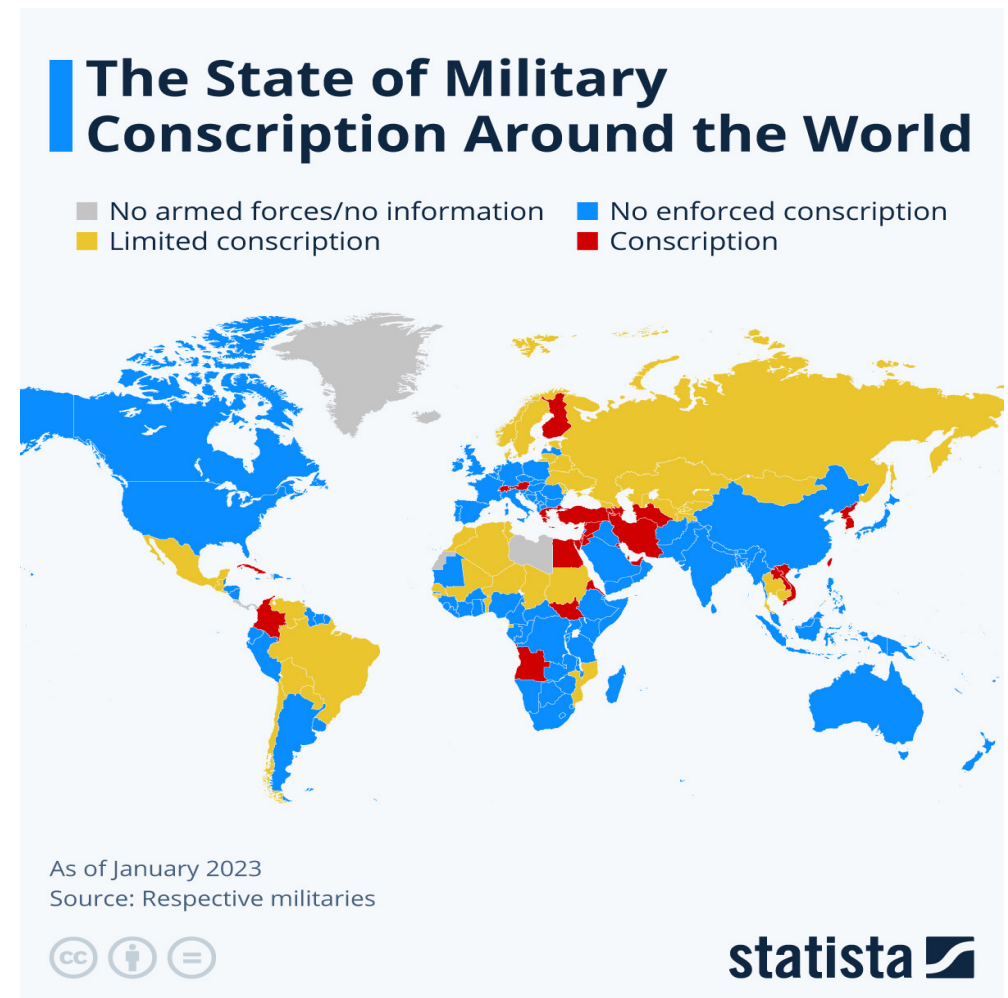


Iraq 2003

- largest involvement of the PMSI in the history of international reconstruction efforts.
- 60 companies employing more than 20,000 private personnel providing military- and security-related services, PMCs are effectively the second largest contingent in Iraq after the US ([DCAF, 2006](#))
- ‘In 2016, 1 in 4 U.S. armed personnel in Iraq and Afghanistan [was a private contractor](#)’ (see op-ed [The Conversation](#))

The (post) Berlin Wall

- Military downsizing worldwide
- Privatisation and New Public Management
- Professionalisation, less conscription



Re-Arm Europe



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We are moving decisively towards a strong and more sovereign Europe of defence

European Council President António Costa, 6 March 2025



Re-Arm Europe



€800 billion of defense expenditures for a safe and resilient Europe



Suspension of EU strict budget rules



New instrument to provide provide €150 billion of loans to member states for defense investment (pan-European capability in air and missile defense, artillery systems, missiles and ammunition drones and anti-drone systems)



Using existing EU budget to fund defense-related investments

Milestones

Set up Capability Coalitions in all priority areas, decide on lead and co-lead nations, and on respective implementation plans until 2030 – by Q1 2026

Collect initial data on EU's defence industrial capacity in the priority capability areas, supported by the Commission as appropriate – by mid-2026

Launch projects in all priority areas within the first half of 2026

Organise at least 40% of defence procurement as joint procurement – by end 2027

Ensure that projects, contracts and financing are in place to close critical capability shortfalls in the prioritised areas – by end 2028

Receive all SAFE-funded procurements, contributing to close all capability shortfalls in the prioritised areas – by end 2030

Flagship Initiatives





<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mFP2m8O2Ex8>

The Violence of Geopolitics Savage Ecology- Grove

- ‘Geopolitics, enacted through global war, is itself a form of life that pursues a savage ecology, radically antagonistic to survival as a collective rather than discriminatory goal’. (Grove, 2019:21)
- **Eurocene.** ‘Five hundred years of geopolitics has built a global savage ecology’ (p. 24)
- Role of militarization and security politics of our contemporary world
- ‘the politics of homogenization as an elite-driven EuroAmerican geopolitics of industrialized war and capitalism made ecocide that is now a global historical fact.
- ‘No anthropogenic, planetary-scale threat faced today— be it nuclear weapons, plastic, climate change, or global war—originated outside the Euro-American circuit of expansion, extractivism, and settlement’ (p. 28)

Conclusions

- **IS PEACE THE CONTINUATION OF WAR BY OTHER MEANS?**
 - We now begin to see that, empires, their wars, and their forms of warfare, are key elements of the modern world.
- **HOW ARE INTERNATIONAL AND DOMESTIC ENTWINED?**
 - That the constitution of militaries is not just a national matter, but has transnational and imperial dimensions, challenges assumed answers to questions such as who fights for who and why.
- **IS WAR MODERN?**
 - War was a condition of political life since the origins of the state about 5,000 years ago in Mesopotamia. What are the limits of thinking only about modern wars?

Next week: Sovereignty, Liberalism, and World Ordering in the 21st Century Conflict (Wolff) .

Required readings:

1. Heywood, A., & Whitham, B. (2023). Global politics (3rd ed., Chapter 10: Power and Twenty-First Century World Order + p83-94 Chapter 3 Traditional Theories of Global politics- Liberalism). London: Red Globe Press.
2. Acharya, Amitav (2023), 'Before the Nation-State: Civilizations, World Orders, and the Origins of Global International Relations' The Chinese Journal of International Politics, 2023, 16, 263–288, <https://doi.org/10.1093/cjip/poad011>

Thank you!



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